

IIT JAM 2026 will be conducted by IIT Bombay on February 15, 2026. IIT JAM Syllabus 2026 will have 7 subjects, which are Biotechnology (BL), Chemistry (CY), Geology (GG), Mathematics (MA), Mathematical Statistics (MS), Economics (EN), and Physics (PH).

- The IIT JAM Syllabus 2026 is categorized into two parts: Section A and Section B. Section A consists of all the core subjects like physics, chemistry, and mathematics, while Section B has optional subjects like Biology, economics, etc.
- Among these subjects, biology holds the most weightage compared to physics, chemistry, and mathematics. Biology has 44% weightage in the whole IIT JAM Syllabus 2026.
- Mathematics and Physics hold equal weightage. Both of these subjects have 18% weightage in the IIT JAM syllabus.
- On the other hand, organic chemistry has 30 to 40% weightage in the IIT JAM 2026 chemistry syllabus.

Ques. Has the IIT JAM 2026 syllabus changed from last year?

- Ans. Yes. There are **minor updates** in the IIT JAM 2026 syllabus-especially in the subjects **Biotechnology, Mathematics, and Mathematical Statistics**, where certain topics have been added or refined.

Ques. Where can I download the official IIT JAM 2026 syllabus PDF?

Ans. You can download the official IIT JAM 2026 syllabus PDF from the conducting body's website - see the subject-wise list of PDFs at the official page of IIT Bombay (the organiser for 2026): [Section-wise detailed IIT JAM syllabus](#).

Ques. How much time does it take to complete the IIT JAM syllabus?

Ans. You can take 5–6 months for the first full round of study. The remaining time goes into revision and mock tests.

What are the Changes in the IIT JAM Syllabus 2026?

- If you're preparing for **IIT JAM 2026**, here's the latest update: **IIT Bombay** has released the **official notification**, and yes, **the syllabus has changed!**
- According to the **official syllabus**, the **IIT JAM 2026 syllabus** for **Biotechnology and allied subjects (Cell Biology, Biochemistry, Genetics, etc.)** has some minor changes with some important topic updates. Some topics have **been removed or merged**, while a few new ones have been added, especially from **GATE BT concepts**.

- While **Physics, Chemistry, and Mathematics** remain mostly unchanged, the **Biological sciences** have seen **major restructuring**.
- Topics like **Protein Targeting and Control of Cell Cycle** have been dropped, while **new inclusions like Hill Coefficient (Biochemistry) and Bioinformatics (Techniques)** have been added.
- So if you're reusing old notes, make sure to update them before starting your 2026 prep.

Subject / Unit	2025 Syllabus Topics	2026 Updates (Additions / Removals)	Remarks for Students
Cell Biology	Protein Targeting in Eukaryotic Cells, Control of Cell Cycle Division, Signaling Pathways, Apoptosis	Removed: Protein Targeting, Control of Cell Cycle Same: Signalling, Apoptosis, Mitosis & Meiosis	Focus on signalling and organelles; skip deleted sections.
Biochemistry	Enzyme Kinetics, Allostery, Glycolysis/TCA Regulation, Vitamins, Metabolism	Added: Hill Coefficient Removed: Allostery, Regulation of Glycolysis/TCA	Include new kinetics concepts; revise metabolic pathways selectively.
Genetics	Mendelian Laws, Linkage, Chromosomal Mapping, Pedigree Analysis, Plant Breeding	Added: Genetic Interactions, Exceptions to Mendelian Law, Chromosomal Mutation & Disorders, Population Genetics Removed: Pedigree Analysis, Plant Breeding	Revise mutations and population genetics; pedigree not required.
Molecular Biology	Replication, Transcription, Translation, Regulation	No Major Changes	Continue using 2025 study material.
Evolution & Ecology	Evolution and Ecology given separately; Population	Merged: Evolution + Ecology into one unit. Removed: Population Genetics (now part of Genetics)	Study both together; fewer direct questions expected from evolution theory

	Genetics under Evolution		
Microbiology	Microbial Genetics, Growth, Metabolism	Added: Bioprocess Topics- Bioreactor, Downstream Processing, Effluent Treatment	New applied topics added; practice from GATE-BT level material.
Plant Biology	Developmental Phases, Flowering, Gametogenesis, Dormancy, Environmental Influence	Added: Tissue Culture, Micropropagation, Transgenic Plants Removed: Developmental Phases, Genetic Control of Flowering	Focus more on Tissue Culture and Plant Biotechnology.
Animal Physiology & Immunology	Standard Topics on Systems & Immunity	Added: MHC Molecules, Tissue Culture, Animal Cloning, Transgenic Animals	Revise Immunology basics + new genetic applications.
Techniques / Biotechnology	Chromatography, Centrifugation, Electrophoresis, Western Blot, ELISA (not mentioned)	Added: ELISA, Bioinformatics, Reorganised Biotech + Techniques as "Biotechniques"	Learn ELISA in-depth and basics of Bioinformatics.
Physics / Chemistry / Maths	Core topics unchanged	<i>No Major Changes</i>	Continue previous year's study plans.

Ques. Should I still refer to the 2025 notes for IIT JAM 2026?

Ans. Yes, but update them. Many topics overlap, but some new ones have been added as discussed above. Compare your old notes with the 2026 official syllabus before starting.

IIT JAM Syllabus 2026: Overview

Category	Details
Conducting Authority	IIT Bombay
Full Form	Indian Institutes of Technology Joint Admission Test for Masters
Courses Offered	Post-Bachelor's Degree Courses
Exam Mode	Online (Computer-Based Test)
IIT JAM Subjects	• Biotechnology (BT) • Chemistry (CY) • Economics (EN) • Geology (GG) • Mathematics (MA) • Mathematical Statistics (MS) • Physics (PH)
Exam Duration	3 Hours
Total Questions	60
Total Marks	100
Question Type	• Multiple Choice Questions (MCQs) • Multiple Select Questions (MSQs) • Numerical Answer Type (NAT)
Paper Pattern	• Section A: 30 MCQsSection B: 10 MSQsSection C: 20 NAT questions
Negative Marking	• Applicable in Section A (MCQs) only • No negative marking in Section B (MSQs) and Section C (NATs)

Ques. What are the participating institutes?

Ans. The participating institutes for the IIT JAM scores are given below:

Participating Institutes	Details
IITs & IISc	All 21 IITs and IISc Bangalore participate in IIT JAM.
NITs & CFTIs	Several NITs and CFTIs also accept JAM scores for M.Sc. admissions through the Centralized Counseling process (CCMN).

Ques. What is the benefit of qualifying IIT JAM?

Ans. The benefits of qualifying for the IIT JAM exam are that you can get opportunities for admission in IITs, IISc, and NITs.

Aspect	Details
Benefits of Qualifying IIT JAM	Opens admission opportunities in IITs, IISc, and NITs for various postgraduate science and technology programs.
Research & Ph.D. Scope	Enhances research opportunities and Ph.D. prospects in India's premier institutes.
Career Growth	Provides access to top institutions, better career options, and strong academic exposure for future advancement.

Ques. How many papers can a candidate appear for?

Ans. The number of papers allowed for the candidates appearing for the IIT JAM exam is given below:

Exam Attempt Rule	Details
Number of Papers Allowed	Candidates can appear for one or two test papers in the IIT JAM.
Condition	The exam schedule must not clash for the selected papers.

IIT JAM Biotechnology (BT) Syllabus 2026:

IIT JAM Biotechnology Syllabus 2026 has four subjects:

- Biology
- Chemistry
- Mathematics
- Physics

The table below shows the [IIT JAM biotechnology syllabus](#) for the session 2026, including key topics:

Chapter	Key Topics
Biotechnology	• Plant tissue culture • Animal cloning (SCNT) • Recombinant DNA applications in medicine • Agriculture & forensics
Cell Biology	• Prokaryotic & eukaryotic cells • Cell Membranes • Cell Organelles • Protein trafficking • Cell communication • ECM • Apoptosis • Cell cycle & division
Biochemistry	• Biomolecules • Enzymes (mechanism, kinetics, inhibition) • Vitamins • Bioenergetics • Metabolism (glycolysis, TCA, photosynthesis, urea cycle).
Genetics	• Mendel's laws • Inheritance • Pedigree analysis • Linkage • Recombination • Gene mapping • Plant breeding

Molecular Biology	• DNA structure • DNA Replication • DNA Repair • Transcription & Translation • Gene expression regulation (operons & eukaryotic).
Evolution	• Natural selection • Fossil record • Population genetics (Hardy-Weinberg) • Genetic drift • Speciation • Origin of life.
Microbiology	• Viruses, bacteria, fungi, protozoa • Microbial growth • Metabolism • Genetics • Fermentation
Plant Biology	• Tissues, growth, transport, nutrition, and flowering • Plant hormones • Photobiology • Stress responses
Animal Biology	• Digestive, circulatory, nervous & endocrine systems • Immunology (innate/adaptive) • Animal development stages
Ecology	• Climate • Biomes • Species distribution • Population factors • Communities • Ecosystems • Remediation
Methods in Biology	• Microscopy, staining, chromatography • Electrophoresis

	• Western blotting • PCR and cloning • DNA sequencing • DNA hybridization
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[One of the Quora users](#) shared his experience, “ How does he start preparing for the IIT JAM in biological sciences in only nine months.

Ques. What are the major subjects included in the IIT JAM Biotechnology 2026 syllabus?

Ans. The major subjects in the IIT JAM Biotechnology 2026 syllabus are **Biology, Chemistry, Physics, and Mathematics**, covering key areas like **Cell and Molecular Biology, Biochemistry, Biophysics, Genetics, Probability, and Statistics**

IIT JAM Chemistry Syllabus 2026:

The table below shows the [IIT JAM chemistry syllabus](#) for the session 2026, including key topics:

Chapter Name	Topics
Structure and properties of Atoms	• Bohr's theory • Periodicity in properties
Bonding in molecules	• Chemical bonding • Complex formation • Physical and chemical basis of molecular interactions
Chemical kinetics, thermodynamics, and equilibrium	• Chemical equilibrium • Chemical thermodynamics • Chemical kinetics
Physical and chemical properties of compounds	• Chemical catalysis • Acid-base concepts • Concepts of pH and buffer • Conjugative effects and resonance • Inductive effects

	• Electromeric effects • Photochemistry • Electrochemistry
Chemistry of organic compounds	• Hydrocarbons • Alkyl halides • Alcohols • Aldehydes • Ketones • Carboxylic acids • Amines and their derivatives • Aromatic hydrocarbons • Halides • Nitro and amino compounds • Phenols, diazonium salts • Carboxylic and sulphonic acids • Soaps and detergents • Stereochemistry of carbon compounds.
Instrumental techniques	• Fundamentals of molecular spectroscopy, emission and absorption spectroscopy • UV-Vis, IR, and 1-D proton NMR spectroscopy • Basics of mass spectrometry • Basics of calorimetry • Basic concepts of crystallography

IIT JAM Physics Syllabus 2026:

The table below shows the [IIT JAM Physics syllabus](#) for the session 2026, including key topics:

Chapter	Key Topics
Mathematical Methods	• Calculus • Partial derivatives • Fourier series • vector calculus • Differential equations • Matrices and determinants

	• Complex numbers
Mechanics & Properties of Matter	• Newton's laws • Motion in different coordinates • Central forces • Kepler's laws • Conservation laws • Collisions • Rigid body motion • Moment of inertia • Fluid dynamics (continuity, Bernoulli's theorem)
Oscillations, Waves & Optics	• SHM, damped & forced oscillations, resonance, wave equation, sound waves • Doppler effect, interference, diffraction, polarization, lenses & image formation.
Electricity & Magnetism	• Coulomb's & Gauss's law • Electric potential, capacitors, dielectrics • Ampere's & Faraday's laws • AC/DC circuits (RLC) • Maxwell's equations • EM waves • Poynting theorem • Lorentz force
Kinetic Theory & Thermodynamics	• Kinetic theory of gases, velocity distribution • Laws of thermodynamics • Entropy • Carnot cycle • Thermodynamic potentials • Phase transitions • Maxwell relations • Statistical distributions (MB, FD, BE)
Modern Physics	• Relativity (postulates, Lorentz transformation) • Photoelectric & Compton effects • Bohr model • Schrödinger equation

	• Quantum principles • Nuclear structure • Radioactivity • Decay laws
Solid State Physics, Devices & Electronics	• Crystal structure • Bragg's law • Semiconductors • p-n junctions, diodes • BJTs, amplifiers, oscillators • OPAMPs, Boolean algebra, and logic gates

[Reddit users from r/IITJAM](#) report that **Mathematical Physics** and **Electromagnetism** determine the top ranks. "Numerical questions dominate Physics, so formulas must be conceptually clear," shared one aspirant.

Ques. What are the most important topics in the IIT JAM Physics 2026 syllabus?

Ans. The most important topics in the IIT JAM Physics 2026 syllabus include Mathematical Methods, Electromagnetism, Oscillations and Waves, Thermodynamics, and Modern Physics, as these carry the highest weightage and are frequently repeated in previous exams.

IIT JAM Mathematics Syllabus 2026:

The table below shows the [IIT JAM Mathematics syllabus](#) for the session 2026, including key topics:

Chapter	Key Topics
Real Analysis	• Sequences & series • Power series • Limits, continuity, differentiation • Taylor's theorem & series • Maxima & minima • Riemann integration • Fundamental theorem of calculus
Multivariable Calculus & Differential Equations	• Functions of 2–3 variables • Partial derivatives • Maxima & minima

	• Double/triple integrals (areas & volumes) • Differential equations- Bernoulli, exact, homogeneous • Cauchy-Euler, linear (1st & 2nd order) • Variation of parameters
Linear Algebra & Algebra	• Matrices • Vector spaces (basis, dimension, linear transformations, rank-nullity) • Groups (cyclic, abelian, normal, quotient) • Lagrange's theorem • Homomorphisms

As per some expert discussion, **Linear Algebra** is the **most scoring topic**, while **Real Analysis** requires the most revision.

The official JAM Math PDF lists “**Power Series: Radius and Interval of Convergence**” among key additions for 2026.

Ques. How difficult is the IIT JAM Mathematics syllabus?

Ans. The IIT JAM Mathematics syllabus is **moderately difficult** - it's concept-heavy but highly scoring for those with strong fundamentals in Calculus, Linear Algebra, and Differential Equations. Consistent practice of PYQs makes it manageable and predictable.

IIT JAM Economics Syllabus 2026:

The table below shows the [IIT JAM Economics syllabus](#) for the session 2026, including key topics:

Section	Key Topics
Microeconomics	• Consumer theory • Theory of production and cost • General equilibrium and welfare • Market structure • Game theory • Public goods • Market failure

Macroeconomics	• National income accounting • Behavioral and technological functions • Business cycles and economic models • Inflation • Unemployment • Business Growth Models
Statistics for Economics	• Probability theory • Mathematical statistics • Hypothesis testing • Correlation Regression
Indian Economy	• Indian economy before 1950, planning and development • Post-1991 reforms • Banking & finance policies • Social inequality • Poverty and the labor market in India
Mathematics for Economics	• Preliminaries and functions • Differential & integral calculus • Differential and difference equations • Linear algebra • Optimization

IIT JAM Geology Syllabus 2026:

The table below shows the [IIT JAM Geology syllabus](#) for the session 2026, including key topics:

Chapter / Area	Key Topics
Planet Earth	• Origin, structure, and composition of Earth.
Mineralogy	• Classification, properties, and identification of minerals.

Applied Geology	• Practical applications of geology in engineering, the environment, and resource exploration.
Planetology	• Study of planets, their formation, and comparison with Earth.
Geomorphology	• Landforms, processes shaping the Earth's surface.
Structural Geology	• Folds, faults, joints, and deformation structures in rocks.
Paleontology	• Fossils, evolution, and the geological time scale.
Stratigraphy	• Principles of stratigraphic correlation and geological history.
Petrology	• Igneous, sedimentary, and metamorphic rocks- origin and classification.
Economic Geology	• Formation and distribution of mineral and energy resources.

[According to a comparative study on the 2026 syllabus by GeoDost](#), the “Planet Earth” section now formally includes principles of radiometric-dating (Rb-Sr, Sm-Nd, ^{14}C) and simultaneously removes topics such as the Earth–Moon system.

Ques. What changes were made to the IIT JAM Geology 2026 syllabus?

Ans. Here are the key changes in the IIT JAM 2026 Geology syllabus compared to 2025:

- The “Planet Earth” section now explicitly includes radiometric-dating methods (e.g., Rb-Sr, Sm-Nd, ^{14}C).
- The “Applied Geology” portion has added content on remote sensing techniques and groundwater flow modelling, beyond just types of aquifers.
- Some earlier topics, like the Earth–Moon system and the shape & size of Earth, appear to be de-emphasised or removed.

IIT JAM Mathematical Statistics Syllabus 2026:

The table below shows the [IIT JAM Mathematical Statistics syllabus](#) for the session 2026, including key topics:

Topic Name	Key Subtopics
Sequences and Series of Real Numbers	• Convergence and limits of sequences • Cauchy and monotonic sequences • Tests for convergence • Alternating and power series • Radius of convergence
Differential Calculus (One & Two Variables)	• Limits, continuity, differentiability • Rolle's and Mean Value Theorems • Taylor's and Maclaurin's series • L'Hospital's rule • Maxima and minima • Partial differentiation • Hessian matrix, and Lagrange multipliers
Integral Calculus	• Fundamental theorems • Differentiation under the integral sign • Improper integrals • Beta and Gamma functions • Double integrals • Change of order • Variable transformation and applications
Matrices and Determinants	• Vector spaces • Linear dependence • Types of matrices • Determinants and properties • Rank, inverse, system of equations, and Cramer's rule • Eigenvalues • Eigenvectors • Cayley-Hamilton theorem

Ques. Is the syllabus the same for all subjects?

Ans. No, the syllabus is subject-specific. Each paper has a unique syllabus, but the exam pattern and marking scheme are common across all papers.

Common Exam Features	Details
Total Marks	100
Total Questions	60
Question Types	MCQ, MSQ, and NAT
Exam Duration	3 Hours
Mode	Computer-Based Test (CBT)

Ques. How should I prioritize topics based on weightage?

Ans. Focus on high-weightage and conceptual topics first for the preparation of the IIT JAM Exam 2026:

Subject	High-Weightage Topics
Physics	• Modern Physics • Thermodynamics
Chemistry	• Organic Chemistry • Physical Chemistry
Economics	• Microeconomics • Macroeconomics
Mathematics	• Real Analysis • Linear Algebra
Biotechnology	• Cell Biology • Biochemistry

Ques. Is the IIT JAM syllabus updated every year?

Ans. The core syllabus remains largely the same each year. However, the conducting IIT may slightly revise or reorganize topics, especially in emerging fields like Biotechnology and Economics.

- Always refer to the official IIT JAM brochure for the latest updates.

Ques. Is there any section-wise cutoff based on syllabus performance?

Ans. No, there's no sectional cutoff in IIT JAM. Your total score out of 100 determines qualification and rank, but balancing all topics is key since questions come from across the syllabus.

IIT JAM Syllabus 2026: Subject-Wise Weightage

IIT JAM has 7 subjects covered in the syllabus. These include Biotechnology, Chemistry, Economics, Geology, Mathematics, Mathematical Statistics, and Physics.

"Past papers are your best guide," [wrote one Reddit user](#). "They reveal at least 70% of repeating concepts."

Ques. Which topics carry the highest marks in IIT JAM 2026?

Ans. The topics that carry the highest marks in IIT JAM 2026 are **Linear Algebra and Calculus** in Mathematics, **Electromagnetism and Waves** in Physics, **Organic Reactions and Thermodynamics** in Chemistry, and **Cell Biology and Genetics** in Biotechnology – based on previous-year paper analysis and expert reviews.

The detailed topic-wise weightage of the IIT JAM syllabus 2026 is provided below.

IIT JAM Biotechnology Syllabus Weightage 2026

The table below shows the topic-wise weightage for IIT JAM Biotechnology (BT) 2026, highlighting the topics for your reference:

Subject	Topic	Weightage (%)
Biology	Molecular Biology, Genetics, Microbiology, Cell Biology	44%
Chemistry	Organic, Inorganic, and Physical Chemistry	20%
Physics	Mechanics, Thermodynamics, Electricity, and Magnetism	18%
Mathematics	Calculus, Linear Algebra, Probability, and Statistics	18%

IIT JAM Geology Syllabus Weightage 2026

The following table shows the topic-wise weightage for IIT JAM Geology (GG) 2026, highlighting the topics for your reference:

Topic Name	Weightage in Percentage
Petrology	27%
Mineralogy	22%
Structural Geology	20%
The Planet Earth	21%
Palaeontology	10%